Akoizo Original Practice - Form 1

Division B | Crime Busters | 50-minute written practice

Original Akoizo curriculum practice. This is not a historical tournament paper. Written build, CAD, lab and communication exercises supplement real practical preparation.

Name: _____ Date: _____

1. (2 points) Which solid turns brown iodine colorless?

Unit: Identifying white powders.
Worked-case data: An unknown white powder is insoluble in water, fizzes strongly with HCl, and leaves iodine yellow-brown. Identify it.
Separate investigation observations:
Appearance: Fine, pure white powder that squeaks when pressed.
Water: Does not dissolve; forms a cloudy suspension.
HCl: No fizzing.
Iodine: Turns blue-black.

A. Vitamin C

B. Cornstarch

C. Table salt

D. Gypsum

Answer: _____

2. (2 points) A human hair usually has a medullary index of:

Unit: Hair and fibers.
Worked-case data: A hair has a continuous medulla about 60% of the hair’s width and scales shaped like petals. What is its source?
Separate investigation observations:
Hair A: Medulla fragmented; index about 0.2.
Hair B: Wide, continuous ladder-like medulla; flattened scales.
Fiber: Burns quickly with afterglow and soft gray ash.

A. Zero always

B. Less than about one-third

C. Greater than one-half

D. Exactly one

Answer: _____

3. (2 points) Why is the starting line drawn in pencil?

Unit: Paper chromatography.
Worked-case data: Ransom-note ink separates into a blue spot at 2.4 cm and a yellow spot at 4.8 cm, with the solvent front at 6.0 cm. Suspect A's pen gives Rf values 0.40 and 0.80; suspect B's gives 0.40 and 0.65. Which pen matches?
Separate investigation observations:
Note ink: Three bands: Rf 0.15, 0.45, 0.70.
Suspect 1 pen: Two bands: Rf 0.45, 0.70.
Suspect 2 pen: Three bands: Rf 0.15, 0.45, 0.70.
Suspect 3 pen: Three bands: Rf 0.20, 0.50, 0.90.

A. Ink is required for Rf

B. Pencil changes Rf values

C. Pencil graphite does not dissolve and separate

D. Pencil speeds up the solvent

Answer: _____

4. (2 points) An analysis must explain the culprit and also:

Unit: Writing the crime scene analysis.
Worked-case data: Evidence: the scene powder is baking soda; suspect A has baking soda, B has cornstarch, C has baking soda. Note ink matches only C's pen. A dog hair was found; A and C own dogs, B owns a cat. Who is the culprit?
Separate investigation observations:
Powder: Calcium carbonate: found with suspects 1 and 3.
Plastic: HDPE fragment: suspects 1, 2, and 3 all use HDPE jugs.
Chromatography: Note ink matches only suspect 3's pen.
Fingerprint: Scene loop matches suspect 3's minutiae.

A. Only the strongest evidence

B. Each suspect's alibi only

C. The price of each test

D. Why the other suspects were not chosen

Answer: _____

5. (2 points) Which liquid is basic with a strong, pungent odor?

Unit: Metals and liquids.
Worked-case data: A silvery metal is not magnetic, reacts vigorously with HCl, and has a density of about 1.7 g/cm^3. Identify it.
Separate investigation observations:
Liquid color: Clear and colorless.
Odor: Little odor.
pH paper: About pH 6, close to neutral.
With yeast: Vigorous foaming and bubbling.

A. Hydrogen peroxide

B. Lemon juice

C. Household ammonia

D. Vinegar

Answer: _____

6. (2 points) Which plastic gives a green flame in the Beilstein test?

Unit: Recyclable plastics.
Worked-case data: A plastic fragment sinks in water, floats in a 1.10 g/cm^3 salt solution, and burns with a sooty flame. Identify it.
Separate investigation observations:
Water: Sinks.
1.10 g/cm^3 solution: Sinks.
1.25 g/cm^3 solution: Floats.
Appearance: Very clear, rigid, and shatter-resistant.

A. PETE

B. HDPE

C. PP

D. PVC

Answer: _____

7. (2 points) An elongated stain’s narrow tail points:

Unit: Fingerprints, DNA, prints, soil, and spatter.
Worked-case data: A scene DNA sample shows peaks at 12 and 15 repeats at location 1, and 8 and 8 at location 2. Suspect X: 12/15 and 8/10. Suspect Y: 12/15 and 8/8. Which suspect matches?
Separate investigation observations:
Scene print: A whorl with two deltas.
Suspect A: Right index finger: loop.
Suspect B: Right index finger: whorl with matching ridge endings.
Suspect C: Right index finger: arch.

A. In the direction of travel

B. Back toward the source

C. Straight up

D. In a random direction

Answer: _____

8. (2 points) Which two solids give a blue-black iodine result?

Unit: Identifying white powders.
Worked-case data: An unknown white powder is insoluble in water, fizzes strongly with HCl, and leaves iodine yellow-brown. Identify it.
Separate investigation observations:
Appearance: Fine, pure white powder that squeaks when pressed.
Water: Does not dissolve; forms a cloudy suspension.
HCl: No fizzing.
Iodine: Turns blue-black.

A. Salt and sugar

B. Sand and gypsum

C. Yeast and gelatin

D. Flour and cornstarch

Answer: _____

9. (2 points) A fiber melts, shrinks from the flame, and forms a hard bead. It is:

A. Synthetic

B. Vegetable

C. Animal

D. Hair

Answer: _____

10. (2 points) A component that clings strongly to the paper will have:

Unit: Paper chromatography.
Worked-case data: Ransom-note ink separates into a blue spot at 2.4 cm and a yellow spot at 4.8 cm, with the solvent front at 6.0 cm. Suspect A's pen gives Rf values 0.40 and 0.80; suspect B's gives 0.40 and 0.65. Which pen matches?
Separate investigation observations:
Note ink: Three bands: Rf 0.15, 0.45, 0.70.
Suspect 1 pen: Two bands: Rf 0.45, 0.70.
Suspect 2 pen: Three bands: Rf 0.15, 0.45, 0.70.
Suspect 3 pen: Three bands: Rf 0.20, 0.50, 0.90.

A. No spot at all

B. A low Rf

C. A high Rf

D. An Rf above 1

Answer: _____

11. (2 points) Which phrase is best for a fiber match?

Unit: Writing the crime scene analysis.
Worked-case data: Evidence: the scene powder is baking soda; suspect A has baking soda, B has cornstarch, C has baking soda. Note ink matches only C's pen. A dog hair was found; A and C own dogs, B owns a cat. Who is the culprit?
Separate investigation observations:
Powder: Calcium carbonate: found with suspects 1 and 3.
Plastic: HDPE fragment: suspects 1, 2, and 3 all use HDPE jugs.
Chromatography: Note ink matches only suspect 3's pen.
Fingerprint: Scene loop matches suspect 3's minutiae.

A. "Identical source"

B. "Certainly from"

C. "Consistent with"

D. "Proves beyond doubt"

Answer: _____

12. (4 points) Why might aluminum react slowly with HCl at first?

Unit: Metals and liquids.
Worked-case data: A silvery metal is not magnetic, reacts vigorously with HCl, and has a density of about 1.7 g/cm^3. Identify it.
Separate investigation observations:
Liquid color: Clear and colorless.
Odor: Little odor.
pH paper: About pH 6, close to neutral.
With yeast: Vigorous foaming and bubbling.

Answer: _____
_____
_____

13. (4 points) Why must air bubbles be removed before a density test?

Unit: Recyclable plastics.
Worked-case data: A plastic fragment sinks in water, floats in a 1.10 g/cm^3 salt solution, and burns with a sooty flame. Identify it.
Separate investigation observations:
Water: Sinks.
1.10 g/cm^3 solution: Sinks.
1.25 g/cm^3 solution: Floats.
Appearance: Very clear, rigid, and shatter-resistant.

Answer: _____
_____
_____

14. (4 points) Explain the difference between class and individual evidence, with an example of each.

Unit: Fingerprints, DNA, prints, soil, and spatter.
Worked-case data: A scene DNA sample shows peaks at 12 and 15 repeats at location 1, and 8 and 8 at location 2. Suspect X: 12/15 and 8/10. Suspect Y: 12/15 and 8/8. Which suspect matches?
Separate investigation observations:
Scene print: A whorl with two deltas.
Suspect A: Right index finger: loop.
Suspect B: Right index finger: whorl with matching ridge endings.
Suspect C: Right index finger: arch.

Answer: _____
_____
_____

15. (4 points) Explain why sodium acetate gives a vinegar smell with HCl.

Unit: Identifying white powders.
Worked-case data: An unknown white powder is insoluble in water, fizzes strongly with HCl, and leaves iodine yellow-brown. Identify it.
Separate investigation observations:
Appearance: Fine, pure white powder that squeaks when pressed.
Water: Does not dissolve; forms a cloudy suspension.
HCl: No fizzing.
Iodine: Turns blue-black.

Answer: _____
_____
_____

16. (4 points) How does wool look under a microscope compared with cotton?

Unit: Hair and fibers.
Worked-case data: A hair has a continuous medulla about 60% of the hair's width and scales shaped like petals. What is its source?
Separate investigation observations:
Hair A: Medulla fragmented; index about 0.2.
Hair B: Wide, continuous ladder-like medulla; flattened scales.
Fiber: Burns quickly with afterglow and soft gray ash.

Answer: _____
_____
_____

17. (4 points) What makes two inks a match on a chromatogram?

Unit: Paper chromatography.
Worked-case data: Ransom-note ink separates into a blue spot at 2.4 cm and a yellow spot at 4.8 cm, with the solvent front at 6.0 cm. Suspect A's pen gives Rf values 0.40 and 0.80; suspect B's gives 0.40 and 0.65. Which pen matches?
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Suspect 2 pen: Three bands: Rf 0.15, 0.45, 0.70.
Suspect 3 pen: Three bands: Rf 0.20, 0.50, 0.90.

Answer: _____
_____
_____

18. (4 points) How should you handle a result that does not fit your conclusion?

Unit: Writing the crime scene analysis.
Worked-case data: Evidence: the scene powder is baking soda; suspect A has baking soda, B has cornstarch, C has baking soda. Note ink matches only C's pen. A dog hair was found; A and C own dogs, B owns a cat. Who is the culprit?
Separate investigation observations:
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Chromatography: Note ink matches only suspect 3's pen.
Fingerprint: Scene loop matches suspect 3's minutiae.

Answer: _____
_____
_____